

Planemakers flex their muscles at Farnborough

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【要点】

- ・ファーンボロー国際航空ショーで€42.4億以上の航空・防衛・宇宙関連取引が発表され、エアバスとボーイングは合わせて約17,000機の受注残を抱えており、生産量の12年分に相当する。
- ・航空会社が急速に新型機を確保しようとする中、メーカーは既存機種受注処理に注力すべきか、次世代航空機の開発に投資すべきかという課題に直面している。
- ・エンブラエルのCEOは、受注残の増加は将来の販売確保につながり、革新的な設計開発を妨げるものではないと主張している。
- ・エアバスは次世代狭胴機を2030年代後半に導入予定であり、航空産業の技術開発サイクルは長期間を要する。

【メール原文】

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure. By JORDYN DAHL with TOMMASO LECCA and MARTINA SAPIO SNEAK PEEK — New orders are

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure.

By JORDYN DAHL

with TOMMASO LECCA and MARTINA SAPIO

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SNEAK PEEK

— New orders are flowing for aircraft manufacturers at the Farnborough International Airshow, but they insist they remain focused on developing the next generation of aircraft despite record order backlogs.

— A second Russia-linked specialized LNG tanker has reached Danish waters, signaling that Denmark's Fayard shipyard could service another vessel underpinning Russia's Arctic LNG exports.

— Electric vehicles became more affordable in Germany from 2020 to 2025, a new report shows.

Good morning, and welcome to Morning Mobility.

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DRIVING THE DAY

AIRCRAFT MANUFACTURERS SHOWCASE NEW ORDERS AT FIA: The Farnborough International Airshow (FIA) is off to a flying start, with more than €42.4 billion worth of deals across the aviation, defense and space sectors announced on the opening day alone, according to calculations by U.K.

industry group ADS.

Fully booked: As usual, Airbus and Boeing are the main contenders in civil aviation, with Brazil's Embraer in third place. Even before airlines placed new orders this week, Airbus and Boeing had a combined backlog of nearly 17,000 aircraft, equivalent to roughly 12 years of production. Embraer said Tuesday it had reached its "all-time record backlog ... that will fuel the production for the next almost four years."

Innovation at risk? With airlines eager to secure new aircraft as quickly as possible and manufacturers already sold out for years, one question is whether they have much incentive to launch clean-sheet aircraft designs rather than focus on clearing their order books.

Not at all: "I think it's the other way around," said Arjan Meijer, CEO of Embraer Commercial Aviation. "A bigger backlog gives us more security for future sales," he told reporters at the airshow. "We are selling more into the future and we see continued demand ... We will be further expanding the backlog ahead of us," he added.

New models take time: Airbus launched the A320neo family about a decade ago. "This generation already brings 15 percent less consumption of fuel," said Bruno Ficheteux, Airbus' head of future programs, citing lower costs and emissions as key drivers of innovation. "Now we are looking at the next generation but in our industry, these are very long cycles," Ficheteux told Tommaso. "We aim to introduce [it] in the second half of the 2030s," he added, referring to Airbus' next narrow-body aircraft.

Beyond the order books: Manufacturers are also using Farnborough to showcase technologies they hope will define the next generation of aviation. Just before the airshow, GE Aerospace, NASA, electric aircraft developer BETA Technologies and Boeing demonstrated a high-altitude hybrid-electric flight.

Vertical flight success: Plane developer Vertical Aerospace announced Monday that it had completed its first public electric vertical takeoff and landing flight at Farnborough, successfully "switching from helicopter mode to airplane mode and back again," the company said in a statement.

MARITIME

SECOND RUSSIAN TANKER HEADS TO DENMARK: A second specialized Arc7 LNG tanker has reached Danish waters, signaling that Denmark's Fayard shipyard could service another vessel underpinning Russia's Arctic LNG exports, according to analysis by campaign group Urgewald .

Reminder: POLITICO reported earlier this month that Fayard, now the only EU shipyard still servicing the specialized Arctic LNG carriers, was racing to maintain the fleet before an EU ban on such work takes effect on Jan. 1, 2027. Campaigners argued maintenance carried out this summer could keep the vessels operational for years after the sanctions enter into force.

The dispute widens: Since then, more than 100 parliamentarians from 17 European countries have urged Fayard to stop accepting any more Arc7 tankers, arguing the work effectively prepares Russia's Yamal LNG fleet to keep operating after the EU embargo. The shipyard has responded directly to lawmakers, defending the work as fully compliant with current EU rules and rejecting suggestions it is doing business with Russia.

Søvndal doubles down: Danish Green MEP Villy Søvndal, who coordinated the letter, acknowledged the maintenance is legal but argued that "legal and legitimate are not the same thing." He said servicing the vessels now amounts to preparing Russia's Arctic LNG trade for the period after Europe has decided to

prohibit both Russian LNG imports under long-term contracts and maintenance services.

Why it matters: With a new vessel, the Georgiy Brusilov, now waiting in Danish waters, according to navigational data, campaigners say the question is no longer whether Fayard will service the Arc7 fleet before the sanctions bite, but whether it will continue doing so despite mounting political pressure.

HORMUZ PRESSURE GROWS: The Strait of Hormuz is again becoming increasingly hazardous for commercial shipping, with a vessel reported to be on fire near the coast of Oman on Monday as U.S. and Iranian strikes continued and fears mounted that the conflict could spill over into other key maritime chokepoints.

Latest incident: The U.K. Maritime Trade Operations said it had received reports of a vessel on fire in the strait, although it did not identify the ship. Adding to the uncertainty, Iran has threatened to ask Yemen's Houthis to close the Bab el-Mandeb Strait. The group has vowed to unveil new measures based on a policy of "siege for siege, airport for airport and port for port," raising concerns that disruption could spread from Hormuz to the Red Sea.

Reminder: Earlier this month, Oxford Economics warned that prolonged tensions between Washington and Tehran could permanently erode the Strait of Hormuz's role as one of the world's most important shipping routes, as operators increasingly avoid the waterway and Gulf states accelerate efforts to diversify export routes. In its worst-case scenario, the consultancy estimated oil prices could top \$130 a barrel in 2027, pushing global growth below 2 percent.

Shipping impact: While traffic through Bab el-Mandeb has continued despite the Red Sea crisis, shipping analyst Lars Jensen warned that a closure comparable to current conditions in Hormuz would severely disrupt regional shipping and Asia-Red Sea container trade. Major carriers like Maersk have also warned customers to expect continued disruption and capacity constraints as the regional security situation deteriorates.

CARS

ELECTRIC VEHICLE PRICES DECLINING IN GERMANY: When adjusted for inflation, all-electric vehicle prices in Germany — Europe's largest car market — declined about 18 percent between 2020 and 2025, according to a new analysis out this week from the International Council on Clean Transportation and the Fraunhofer Institute.

Silver lining: The prices declined when looking at comparable models. The median price of an EV in Germany, however, increased 42 percent, from €38,000 in 2020 to €54,000 in 2025. The study points to automakers putting larger models like SUVs, which come with a higher price tag, on the market.

On the flip side: The median price for an internal combustion engine car in Germany, meanwhile, increased 15 percent, from €41,000 to €46,000.

Everything's bigger in Texas Germany: The number of EV models has skyrocketed in Germany, going from 38 in 2020 to 159 in 2025, but SUVs and other medium and large-sized models now account for 73 percent of all EVs on the market, the report says. Mini and small models comprise 14 percent of the market.

A case for small cars: The EU institutions are in the middle of negotiating the automotive package put forward by the Commission last year that includes a new small EV category. The executive offered automakers more flexibility in meeting emission targets if they invest in small EVs — an initiative

introduced by Commission President Ursula von der Leyen.

The battery equation: The most lucrative — and expensive — component in an electric vehicle is the battery. The ICCT study shows that while global battery prices have come down, those drops are not yet being passed on to the consumer. “The significant drop in battery costs has not yet fully translated into lower list prices. This means that the potential for further price reductions in electric vehicles has not yet been exhausted,” Patrick Plötz, one of the study’s authors, said in a press release .

HUNGARY TO INVESTIGATE FORMER MINISTER’S DEALS WITH BYD: In a speech before Hungary’s parliament on Monday, Prime Minister Péter Magyar announced his government will be investigating the investments from Chinese automaker BYD in the country. The investigation comes on the heels of former Foreign Minister Péter Szijjártó leaving government for a senior role at the automaker .

Catch up: Beijing had a close relationship with Budapest under former Prime Minister Viktor Orbán, who courted Chinese investors with the relationship peaking in 2024 , after Premier Xi Jinping ended his first Europe tour with a trip to Hungary. The coziness paid off in the form of electric vehicle and battery investments, with CATL and BYD both choosing Hungary to set up shop.

Not a coincidence: Magyar’s investigation will look at all of Szijjártó’s “decisions, negotiations and state commitments related to the BYD Hungary investment” the prime minister said in his speech, calling the former minister’s new employment at the automaker “no coincidence.” Szijjártó helped BYD with “hundreds of billions in public money, diplomatic support and state infrastructure,” Magyar said.

FINNISH INDUSTRY MINISTER WARY OF EUROPEAN PREFERENCE: The Nordic country has reservations about the Industrial Accelerator Act — the Commission’s grand strategy to boost competitiveness across the EU through local content requirements and tighter foreign direct investment rules. “We believe that the IAA requirements work only if there is sufficient competition in the market,” Matias Marttinen, Finland’s competition minister, told our colleague Francesca Micheletti.

PIT STOPS

Tariffs aren’t stopping Chinese automakers from flooding Mexico with their electric vehicles, Reuters reports.

Headlines

Here’s a recap of yesterday’s news, along with Pro articles and alerts from overnight.

Trump says midterms won’t impact his Iran war plan

Republicans are increasingly anxious over the potential ramifications of the war amid rising gas prices and the death of three troops since fighting resumed.

By Emilio Perez Ibarguen, Carlos Anchondo, Mike Soraghan · Jul 21, 2026, 10:02 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

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